



Key takeaways from the Deutsche Bank Global Auto, Mobility & Robotics Conference

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Held at the Deutsche Bank Center in New York, the recent Global Autos, Mobility & Robotics Conference brought together industry leaders for two days of discussions on innovation, strategy, and the next generation of solutions and capabilities. The event provided a comprehensive view of how the sector is evolving – highlighting both near-term resilience and the structural shifts reshaping the industry. From changing demand dynamics and geopolitical pressures to the rise of new technologies and growth areas, the conversations underscore a sector in transition. These key conference themes capture the core insights shaping the outlook for autos, mobility, and robotics today.

Resilience for now, but risks building

Auto markets in Europe and the US remain relatively resilient, with demand holding up better than expected in the near term. However, visibility is limited and companies are increasingly cautious about the outlook. Geopolitical tensions – particularly in the Middle East – are a key risk, with the potential to push up costs and weigh on demand. While impacts so far have been contained, a more challenging environment is expected if pressures persist into 2027.

Costs rising, pricing power limited

Cost pressures are building across energy, raw materials, and logistics, and are starting to flow through supply chains. While companies have partly offset this through hedging and cost controls, pricing power remains limited – especially in the US and Europe. Rather than raising prices directly, firms are relying on product mix and model upgrades, creating ongoing tension between protecting margins and sustaining demand.

Geopolitics driving cost pressures

Direct exposure to the Middle East remains limited for most companies, but the conflict is beginning to impact costs – particularly in energy and logistics. While hedging has softened the near-term effect, pressures are expected to build into 2027 as protections roll off. Early signs of supply chain inflation are emerging, with higher costs gradually passed through the system, often with a lag, and companies stepping up efficiency measures to offset the impact on margins.

New growth areas emerging beyond autos

Suppliers are increasingly looking beyond automotive markets to drive future growth, targeting areas such as data centres, energy systems, and defence. While these segments remain small today, they are seen as important medium-term opportunities. Continued investment and partnerships are expected to gradually scale these businesses and diversify revenue streams over time.

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China reshaping global competition

Chinese automakers are rapidly expanding internationally, gaining share across Europe, Southeast Asia, and South America. This is reshaping competitive dynamics and forcing established players to adapt through localisation, pricing changes, and new partnerships. For suppliers, aligning with Chinese exporters presents growth opportunities, but also intensifies competition and pricing pressure in global markets.

EV momentum moderating

EV growth is continuing but at a slower pace, as consumer demand shifts toward hybrids and traditional vehicles. In response, companies are taking a more balanced approach to powertrain strategies and scaling back the pace of EV investment. This reflects a more pragmatic, demand-led approach, with hybrids benefiting from extended lifecycles and a broader mix of technologies gaining prominence.

Efficiency and restructuring a key focus

Companies are stepping up efforts to improve efficiency, including restructuring programmes, underutilized plant closures, and footprint reductions. These measures aim to protect margins in a more uncertain environment. At the same time, adoption of automation and AI is accelerating, as firms seek to streamline operations and build more flexible, cost-efficient business models.



Appendix 1

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